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ARTICLE

The Quiet Compromise: Christian Colleges' Growing Ties To The Abortion Industry

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BY PNW STAFF MARCH 11, 2026

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For generations, Christian parents have sacrificed, saved, and prayed so their children could attend universities that claim to be grounded in biblical truth. These schools promise something rare in modern higher education: a place where faith is not mocked but nurtured, where Scripture shapes the worldview of the next generation.

Yet a shocking new report suggests that many institutions bearing the name of Christ have quietly compromised one of the most fundamental teachings of the Christian faith -- the sanctity of human life.

According to a new nationwide study, one in seven Christian colleges and universities in the United States now has some form of connection to the abortion industry. For many believers, that statistic is almost unthinkable. But the numbers are real, and they raise serious questions about what "Christian" actually means in the context of modern higher education.

The findings come from the 2025 Christian Schools Project conducted by the Demetree Institute for Pro-Life Advancement. Researchers examined 725 colleges and universities affiliated with denominations that publicly claim a historic Christian foundation. These were not secular schools with religious roots buried somewhere in the distant past. These institutions actively present themselves as faith-based.

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Yet the study found that 114 of those schools maintain ties to abortion providers, most commonly through connections with Planned Parenthood, the nation's largest abortion provider. These connections vary in form but include promoting internships with abortion organizations, listing them as healthcare resources for students, advertising their events, or incorporating their materials into coursework.

Researchers found that support for Planned Parenthood or similar abortion-linked services at Christian colleges has increased nearly 20 percent since 2022, the year the U.S. Supreme Court overturned Roe v. Wade and returned abortion laws to the states.

In other words, while many Christians celebrated the historic pro-life victory that ended federal protection for abortion, some institutions that claim to represent Christian values moved in the opposite direction.

For believers who view abortion not simply as a political issue but as a profound moral tragedy, the implications are staggering.

Christians have historically taught that every human life is created in the image of God and therefore possesses inherent dignity and worth. Scripture repeatedly affirms God's intimate involvement in the creation of life in the womb. To many faithful believers, abortion represents the deliberate destruction of that life -- the killing of an innocent child.

From that perspective, the idea that a Christian university might direct students toward abortion providers for internships or healthcare resources represents not just institutional drift but moral collapse.

The report also reveals where many of these compromises are concentrated.

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Among the denominations surveyed, Methodist-affiliated institutions accounted for the largest share of infractions, representing nearly 37 percent of all violations identified in the report. Catholic-affiliated schools made up just under 25 percent of infractions, despite the Catholic Church's longstanding and unequivocal opposition to abortion.

The study graded schools on a scale ranging from A-plus -- meaning no ties to the abortion industry and active support for pregnancy resource centers -- down to F for institutions with four or more infractions.

Forty-seven schools received failing grades.

One of the most striking examples cited in the report was American University in Washington, D.C., a Methodist-affiliated institution chartered by Congress in 1893. Researchers documented 34 separate infractions, including programs that involved working with Planned Parenthood as part of student service initiatives.

Another example was Hope College in Michigan, affiliated with the Reformed Church in America. The report found 14 infractions, including the listing of abortion counselor as a possible career path for sociology majors.

For many Christians reading these findings, the sense of betrayal is profound.

Parents send their children to Christian colleges trusting that those institutions will reinforce biblical convictions, not undermine them. Donors contribute millions of dollars believing they are supporting schools that will stand firm on foundational moral issues. Churches recommend these universities as safe environments for spiritual and intellectual growth.

The reality is that many universities founded by Christians have gradually drifted from their roots. Some still maintain religious language in their mission statements while quietly adopting the moral framework of the surrounding culture.

And nowhere is that tension more visible than on the issue of abortion.

Yet the report also includes signs of hope.

The number of schools receiving A-plus grades increased nearly 14 percent between 2024 and 2025, suggesting that many institutions are taking steps to strengthen their pro-life commitments.

Some universities have created on-campus housing for pregnant students, partnered with pregnancy resource centers, or actively removed abortion providers from their recommended resources.

In fact, the report notes that roughly 50 ties between Christian colleges and Planned Parenthood were eliminated between 2024 and 2025 after awareness efforts brought attention to the issue.

Those victories show that change is possible when believers pay attention and hold institutions accountable.

But they also highlight a larger lesson for Christian families.

Choosing a college should never be based on the word "Christian" alone.

Parents and students must look deeper. They must examine whether a school truly upholds biblical teachings in practice -- not just in marketing brochures. What organizations does the school partner with? What worldview is being taught in classrooms? What moral vision shapes campus life?

These questions matter because college is not just an academic experience. It is one of the most formative seasons in a young person's life.

Students will leave campus not only with degrees but with convictions that will shape their families, careers, and faith for decades to come.

For Christians who believe that every life in the womb matters to God, the stakes could not be higher.

A university that quietly normalizes abortion while claiming the name of Christ is not simply failing academically or administratively. It is failing spiritually.

And for the next generation of Christian leaders, that failure carries consequences far beyond the classroom.

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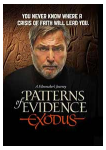

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